IELTS Level 4.4 Advanced Economics Test - Test Results

Submission ID: mhn2rwpsd7znfv66g9a

Test Date: 2025-11-05

Submission Date: November 6th 2025, 1:58:13 pm

Test Summary

Grammar & Vocabulary:	11/20 (Band 5)
Reading:	30/30 (Band 9)
Listening:	22/40 (Band 5.5)
Writing:	13/20 (Band 6)
Overall IELTS Band Score:	**5.7**
Total Raw Score:	69.09/100
Time Spent:	52:07

Grammar & Language Use

Question 1

Had the central bank _____ interest rates earlier, the inflation surge might have been contained.

A) raised

B) raise

C) raising

D] been raised

Explanation: Past perfect in third conditional

Question 2

Not until the financial crisis _____ the vulnerabilities in the global banking system.

A) regulators understood

B) did regulators understand

C) regulators had understood

D] understood regulators

Explanation: Inversion after negative adverbial

Question 3

The trade agreement, _____ provisions cover digital commerce, represents a new generation of economic partnerships.

A) who

B) whom

C) which

D] whose

Explanation: Possessive relative pronoun

Question 4

_____ the economic headwinds, emerging markets demonstrated remarkable resilience.

A) Despite

B) Although

C) Because of

D] However

Explanation: Preposition for contrast

Question 5

The IMF recommended that the government _____ its fiscal stimulus measures.

A) maintain

B) maintains

C) maintained

D] maintaining

Explanation: Subjunctive after verbs of recommendation

Question 6

So complex _____ that few economists predicted its full impact.

A) the financial system was

B) was the financial system

C) the financial system had been

D] had the financial system been

Explanation: Inversion after 'so + adjective'

Question 7

The economic reforms, _____ implemented gradually, have yielded significant productivity gains.

A) to be

B) being

C) been

D] having been

Explanation: Perfect participle for completed action

Question 8

_____ the central bank's intervention, currency volatility persisted.

A) Notwithstanding

B) Besides

C) Moreover

D] Therefore

Explanation: Formal preposition meaning 'despite'

Question 9

The corporation is one _____ global supply chain spans over fifty countries.

A) that

B) which

C) whose

D] where

Explanation: Possessive relative pronoun

Question 10

_____ was the economic recovery that unemployment fell to record lows.

A) Such

B) So

C) Very

D] Too

Explanation: 'Such' with noun in result clause

Question 11

The policy committee, all of _____ had extensive economic training, reached a unanimous decision.

A) who

B) whom

C) which

D] them

Explanation: Relative pronoun after preposition

Question 12

Little _____ the profound transformation that digitalization would bring to global commerce.

A) economists anticipated

B) anticipated economists

C) did economists anticipate

D] had economists anticipated

Explanation: Inversion after negative adverb

Question 13

The market reaction was _____ severe that trading had to be temporarily suspended.

A) so

B) such

C) too

D] very

Explanation: 'So' with adjective in result clause

Question 14

_____ the coordinated policy response, the financial system stabilized.

A) Due to

B) Owing to

C) Thanks to

D] Because

Explanation: Expression for positive cause and effect

Question 15

The board insisted that the merger _____ completed by the quarter's end.

A) be

B) is

C) was

D] were

Explanation: Subjunctive after verbs of demand

Question 16

No sooner _____ the economic data released than markets reacted violently.

A) had

B) did

C) was

D] has

Explanation: Past perfect in 'no sooner' construction

Question 17

The fiscal stimulus package, _____ on Keynesian principles, aimed to boost aggregate demand.

A) basing

B) based

C) having based

D] being based

Explanation: Reduced relative clause in passive

Question 18

Such _____ the complexity of modern finance that specialized regulation became necessary.

A) was

B) were

C) is

D] are

Explanation: Inversion after 'such' with singular noun

Question 19

The economic indicators were _____ promising that investors regained confidence.

A) so

B) such

C) too

D] very

Explanation: 'So' with adjective in result clause

Question 20

_____ all the economic uncertainties, global trade continued to expand.

A) In spite of

B) Because of

C) Due to

D] Owing to

Explanation: Expression for contrast

Reading

Passage 1: The Evolution of Global Value Chains

Global value chains (GVCs) have transformed international trade and production patterns over recent decades, creating complex networks of cross-border economic activity. The fragmentation of production processes across multiple countries has enabled firms to leverage comparative advantages at each stage of value creation. This disintegration of production has been facilitated by technological advances in communication and transportation, trade liberalization, and the reduction of coordination costs. Developing countries' participation in GVCs has provided opportunities for technological upgrading and industrial development, though the distribution of gains remains uneven. The smile curve hypothesis illustrates how value addition is concentrated in pre-production (R&D, design) and post-production (marketing, services) activities, while manufacturing captures relatively lower value. Recent trends include the digitalization of GVCs, the rise of servicification, and growing attention to sustainability concerns. Geopolitical tensions and pandemic disruptions have highlighted vulnerabilities in highly optimized GVCs, prompting reconsideration of resilience versus efficiency trade-offs. The future evolution of GVCs will likely involve greater regionalization, digital integration, and reconfiguration to address both economic and non-economic objectives including security, sustainability, and equity.

Question reading-q1

What have global value chains transformed?

A) A) Domestic policies

B) B) International trade patterns

C) C) Currency systems

D) D] Labor markets

Question reading-q2

What has enabled production fragmentation?

A) A) Government regulations

B) B) Technological advances

C) C) Cultural homogenization

D) D] Climate agreements

Question reading-q3

What opportunities has GVC participation provided?

A) A) Political influence

B) B) Technological upgrading

C) C) Cultural exchange

D) D] Military alliances

Question reading-q4

What does the smile curve illustrate?

A) A) Value addition distribution

B) B) Production efficiency

C) C) Trade balances

D) D] Employment patterns

Question reading-q5

Where is value concentrated according to the smile curve?

A) A) Manufacturing

B) B) Pre and post-production

C) C) Transportation

D) D] Raw materials

Question reading-q6

What recent trend is mentioned?

A) A) Digitalization

B) B) Nationalization

C) C) Agricultural focus

D) D] Military production

Question reading-q7

What have pandemic disruptions highlighted?

A) A) GVC vulnerabilities

B) B) Trade benefits

C) C) Cost advantages

D) D] Technological superiority

Question reading-q8

What trade-off is being reconsidered?

A) A) Cost and quality

B) B) Resilience and efficiency

C) C) Speed and accuracy

D) D] Innovation and tradition

Question reading-q9

What future evolution is predicted?

A) A) Complete globalization

B) B) Greater regionalization

C) C) Total localization

D) D] Stagnation

Question reading-q10

What non-economic objectives are mentioned?

A) A) Security and sustainability

B) B) Cultural preservation

C) C) Political stability

D) D] Religious freedom

Passage 2: Modern Monetary Theory and Policy Debates

Modern Monetary Theory (MMT) has sparked intense debate among economists and policymakers by challenging conventional understandings of fiscal and monetary policy constraints. MMT proponents argue that countries issuing sovereign currency in a floating exchange rate system face no financial constraints on spending, though they remain subject to real resource constraints. According to this framework, the primary risk of excessive government spending is inflation rather than insolvency. This perspective reinterprets the role of taxes, suggesting they primarily function to control inflation and create demand for currency rather than to fund government expenditure. Critics contend that MMT

underestimates inflation risks and the practical political economy challenges of implementing its prescriptions. They argue that the theory fails to adequately account for exchange rate volatility, capital flight, and the confidence mechanisms underlying modern fiat currencies. The MMT debate has highlighted fundamental questions about the nature of money, the relationship between fiscal and monetary authorities, and the appropriate policy responses to secular stagnation and climate change. While mainstream economics remains skeptical of MMT's core propositions, the theory has influenced discussions about the scope for expansionary fiscal policy in low-inflation environments and the potential for direct central bank financing of public investment in extraordinary circumstances.

Question reading-q11

What has MMT challenged?

A) A) Economic growth theories

B) B) Conventional policy constraints

C) C) Trade theory

D) D] Development models

Question reading-q12

What constraints do currency-issuing countries face according to MMT?

A) A) Financial constraints

B) B) Real resource constraints

C) C) Political constraints

D) D] Legal constraints

Question reading-q13

What is the primary risk of excessive spending?

A) A) Insolvency

B) B) Inflation

C) C) Unemployment

D) D] Trade deficits

Question reading-q14

How does MMT reinterpret taxes?

A) A) As funding mechanism

B) B) As inflation control

C) C) As wealth redistribution

D) D] As behavioral incentive

Question reading-q15

What do critics say MMT underestimates?

A) A) Growth potential

B) B) Inflation risks

C) C) Technological change

D) D] Demographic trends

Question reading-q16

What practical challenges do critics mention?

A) A) Implementation challenges

B) B) Measurement problems

C) C) Data limitations

D) D] Theoretical inconsistencies

Question reading-q17

What does MMT fail to account for according to critics?

A) A) Exchange rate volatility

B) B) Productivity growth

C) C) Income distribution

D) D] Environmental costs

Question reading-q18

What fundamental questions has the debate highlighted?

A) A) About the nature of money

B) B) About economic growth

C) C) About trade patterns

D) D] About development

Question reading-q19

How does mainstream economics view MMT?

A) A) Supportive

B) B) Skeptical

C) C) Neutral

D) D] Unaware

Question reading-q20

What has MMT influenced discussions about?

A) A) Expansionary fiscal policy

B) B) Monetary policy independence

C) C) Trade liberalization

D) D] Financial regulation

Passage 3: The Economics of Innovation and Technological Change

The economics of innovation represents a critical frontier in understanding long-term economic growth and competitiveness. Traditional growth models emphasized capital accumulation and labor inputs, while contemporary frameworks recognize knowledge creation and technological progress as fundamental drivers of productivity enhancement. The concept of endogenous growth theory formalizes how investments in human capital, innovation, and knowledge contribute to economic growth, challenging the assumption of diminishing returns to capital. Innovation exhibits distinctive economic characteristics: it involves significant uncertainty, generates knowledge spillovers, and often requires complementary investments. These features create market failures that justify public intervention through intellectual property rights, research subsidies, and innovation ecosystems. The digital transformation has accelerated innovation dynamics while introducing new challenges related to data governance, platform economics, and the distribution of innovation rents. Recent research emphasizes the importance of innovation systems that connect universities, firms, and government institutions in knowledge creation and diffusion. The geography of innovation has become increasingly important, with innovation clusters demonstrating agglomeration economies and knowledge networks. Addressing grand challenges like climate change and public health requires mission-oriented innovation policies that coordinate public and private efforts toward specific technological goals. Understanding the institutional and policy conditions that foster innovation while ensuring broad distribution of its benefits remains a central challenge in innovation economics.

Question reading-q21

What do contemporary growth frameworks recognize?

A) A) Capital accumulation

B) B) Knowledge creation

C) C) Resource extraction

D) D] Trade surpluses

Question reading-q22

What does endogenous growth theory challenge?

A) A) Innovation importance

B) B) Diminishing returns

C) C) Market efficiency

D) D] Government role

Question reading-q23

What distinctive characteristic does innovation exhibit?

A) A) Certain returns

B) B) Knowledge spillovers

C) C) Limited impact

D) D] Predictable outcomes

Question reading-q24

What do these features create?

A) A) Market failures

B) B) Perfect competition

C) C) Price stability

D) D] Trade balances

Question reading-q25

What justifies public intervention?

A) A) Market failures

B) B) Political pressure

C) C) Budget surpluses

D) D] International competition

Question reading-q26

What has the digital transformation accelerated?

A) A) Innovation dynamics

B) B) Economic cycles

C) C) Population growth

D) D] Resource depletion

Question reading-q27

What do innovation systems connect?

A) A) Universities and firms

B) B) Banks and corporations

C) C) Governments and citizens

D) D] Producers and consumers

Question reading-q28

What demonstrates agglomeration economies?

A) A) Innovation clusters

B) B) Rural areas

C) C) Small towns

D) D] Isolated regions

Question reading-q29

What do mission-oriented policies coordinate?

A) A) Public and private efforts

B) B) Domestic and foreign policy

C) C) Economic and social policy

D) D] Fiscal and monetary policy

Question reading-q30

What remains a central challenge?

A) A) Fostering innovation and benefit distribution

B) B) Reducing innovation costs

C) C) Speeding up innovation

D) D] Controlling innovation direction

Listening

Part 1: Conversation about international trade agreement

Script: {"narrator":"Good morning. This is the International English Language Testing System, IELTS. You will hear a number of different recordings and you will have to answer questions on what you hear. Ther...

Question listening-q1

What is the main topic of discussion?

A) A) Environmental regulations

B) B) International trade agreement

C) C) Financial market reforms

D) D) Technology transfer

Question listening-q2

What is the proposed tariff reduction schedule?

A) A) 10 years

B) B) 15 years

C) C) 20 years

D) D) 25 years

Question listening-q3

What GDP boost is predicted for developed nations?

A) A) 2.5%

B) B) 3.2%

C) C) 4.1%

D) D) 5.3%

Question listening-q4

Which sectors might experience contraction in developing economies?

A) A) Agriculture

B) B) Manufacturing

C) C) Services

D) D) Technology

Question listening-q5

What is proposed to address equity concerns?

A) A) Uniform implementation

B) B) Graduated timelines

C) C) Complete exemption

D) D] Bilateral agreements

Question listening-q6

Which indicators are suggested for implementation schedules?

A) A) HDI and GDP per capita

B) B) Inflation and unemployment

C) C) Trade balance and debt

D) D] Population and area

Question listening-q7

What concern is raised about intellectual property?

A) A) Enforcement costs

B) B) Access to medicines

C) C) Technology transfer

D) D] Copyright duration

Question listening-q8

What patent period is suggested for least developed countries?

A) A) 5 years

B) B) 8 years

C) C) 12 years

D) D] 15 years

Question listening-q9

What issue is mentioned regarding digital trade?

A) A) Data localization

B) B) Internet access

C) C) Digital literacy

D) D] Cybersecurity

Question listening-q10

Which framework is suggested for data flows?

A) A) US model

B) B) EU adequacy decisions

C) C) Chinese system

D) D] UN guidelines

Part 2: Monologue about monetary policy frameworks

Script: {"narrator":"Now turn to Part 2. You will hear a lecture on modern monetary policy frameworks. Look at questions 11 to 20. You now have some time to look at the questions.\n\n[Pause]\n\nNow listen car...

Question listening-q11

What paradigm dominated the late 20th century?

A) A) Financial stability targeting

B) B) Inflation targeting

C) C) Employment maximization

D) D] Exchange rate stability

Question listening-q12

What is incorporated alongside price stability?

A) A) Political considerations

B) B) Financial stability

C) C) Trade balances

D) D] Fiscal policy

Question listening-q13

What remains the traditional inflation target?

A) A) 1%

B) B) 2%

C) C) 3%

D) D] 4%

Question listening-q14

What has become a standard tool during crises?

A) A) Interest rate cuts

B) B) Quantitative easing

C) C) Currency intervention

D) D] Reserve requirements

Question listening-q15

What presents complex challenges during normalization?

A) A) Political pressure

B) B) Market expectations

C) C) International coordination

D) D] Technological limitations

Question listening-q16

What is being integrated into monetary policy?

A) A) Climate risk

B) B) Demographic trends

C) C) Technological change

D) D] Geopolitical factors

Question listening-q17

Where are environmental considerations applied?

A) A) Interest rate decisions

B) B) Collateral frameworks

C) C) Currency design

D) D] Bank supervision

Question listening-q18

What is reshaping the monetary transmission mechanism?

A) A) Digital currencies

B) B) Cryptocurrencies

C) C) Payment apps

D) D] Blockchain technology

Question listening-q19

What questions do digital currencies raise?

A) A) About monetary sovereignty

B) B) About financial inclusion

C) C) About bank profitability

D) D] About tax collection

Question listening-q20

What approach is now necessary?

A) A) Technical approach

B) B) Holistic approach

C) C) Conservative approach

D) D] Experimental approach

Part 3: Discussion about behavioral economics applications

Script: {"narrator":"Now turn to Part 3. You will hear a discussion between a behavioral economist and a policy analyst about applying behavioral insights to public policy. Look at questions 21 to 30. You now...

Question listening-q21

What has demonstrated potential for improving policy?

A) A) Traditional economics

B) B) Behavioral economics

C) C) Political science

D) D] Management theory

Question listening-q22

What theory is mentioned as influential?

A) A) Game theory

B) B) Nudge theory

C) C) Agency theory

D) D] Rational choice theory

Question listening-q23

What successful example is given?

A) A) Tax compliance

B) B) Retirement savings

C) C) Health insurance

D) D] Education savings

Question listening-q24

What ethical concern is raised?

A) A) Cost effectiveness

B) B) Choice manipulation

C) C) Implementation difficulty

D) D] Measurement problems

Question listening-q25

What key ethical principle is suggested?

A) A) Efficiency

B) B) Transparency

C) C) Universality

D) D] Simplicity

Question listening-q26

What risk does the policy analyst mention?

A) A) Technocratic paternalism

B) B) Democratic deficit

C) C) Bureaucratic inertia

D) D] Political interference

Question listening-q27

What challenge is mentioned about scalability?

A) A) Addressing systemic issues

B) B) Measuring outcomes

C) C) Training staff

D) D] Securing funding

Question listening-q28

How should behavioral interventions relate to traditional tools?

A) A) Replace them

B) B) Complement them

C) C) Oppose them

D) D] Ignore them

Question listening-q29

What increased tax compliance effectively?

A) A) Higher penalties

B) B) Simplified forms

C) C) More auditors

D) D] Public shaming

Question listening-q30

What must be addressed with digital governance?

A) A) Technical capacity

B) B) Data privacy

C) C) User interface

D) D] Internet access

Part 4: Lecture on economic complexity and development

Script: {"narrator":"Now turn to Part 4. You will hear a lecture on economic complexity and development pathways. Look at questions 31 to 40. You now have some time to look at the questions.\n\n[Pause]\n\nNow...

Question listening-q31

What does the economic complexity approach represent?

A) A) Technical improvement

B) B) Paradigm shift

C) C) Policy failure

D) D] Measurement error

Question listening-q32

What do traditional metrics fail to capture?

A) A) Income inequality

B) B) Productive knowledge

C) C) Environmental impact

D) D] Social welfare

Question listening-q33

What does the Economic Complexity Index measure?

A) A) Export diversity and sophistication

B) B) Import dependency

C) C) Trade balance

D) D] Tariff levels

Question listening-q34

What benefit do high-complexity countries demonstrate?

A) A) Lower taxes

B) B) Greater resilience

C) C) Faster growth

D) D] Larger population

Question listening-q35

What concept explains development paths?

A) A) Comparative advantage

B) B) Relatedness

C) C) Path dependency

D) D] Competitive advantage

Question listening-q36

What do economies tend to develop?

A) A) Unrelated industries

B) B) Closely related industries

C) C) Service sectors

D) D] Agricultural sectors

Question listening-q37

What should governments do instead of picking winners?

A) A) Remove bottlenecks

B) B) Provide subsidies

C) C) Impose tariffs

D) D] Control prices

Question listening-q38

What should investments focus on?

A) A) Existing industries

B) B) Adjacent capabilities

C) C) High-tech sectors

D) D] Basic infrastructure

Question listening-q39

What does the complexity framework help explain?

A) A) Resource curse

B) B) Trade deficits

C) C) Inflation patterns

D) D] Currency fluctuations

Question listening-q40

What type of economy is becoming increasingly important?

A) A) Agricultural economy

B) B) Industrial economy

C) C) Knowledge-based economy

D) D] Service economy

Writing

Writing Task 1

Prompt: undefined

The graph shows how much government debt made up the GDP of Japan, the United States, Italy, and Germany from 2000 to 2025. Overall, Japan had the highest debt during the whole period, while Germany had the lowest. Most countries saw their debt increase, except Germany which managed to reduce it. In 2000, Japan's debt was already around 140% of its GDP and kept rising to about 260% by 2025. The United States started with about 55% and went up to more than 120%. Italy stayed near 100% until 2010, then slowly increased to around 150% in 2025. Germany's debt rose a little until 2010, but after that it went down to below 70% by 2025. In general, Japan and the U.S. had the biggest growth in debt, while Germany was the only country that succeeded in cutting it down

Writing Task 2

Prompt: undefined

Some people think globalization mainly helps rich countries and big companies, while others believe it brings benefits to many people and helps the world develop. On one hand, globalization allows powerful nations and corporations to expand their influence. Large companies often move their factories to poorer countries where labor is cheap, which can lead to worker exploitation and low wages. In some cases, factories harm the environment by polluting air and water to cut costs. Meanwhile, rich countries gain most of the profit through trade and

technology, leaving poorer nations dependent and less able to grow on their own. On the other hand, globalization has also improved many lives. It has created millions of jobs in developing countries, allowing people to earn money and escape poverty. It also encourages the exchange of ideas, culture, and technology between countries. This has helped improve education, medicine, and innovation around the world. In my opinion, globalization is not completely good or bad. It has brought real progress, but the benefits are not shared equally. Governments and international organizations should make sure that companies follow fair labor laws and protect the environment, so that globalization can support both people and the planet